

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Debert Stewart

Address: 56 Belmont Road Belmont SM2 6DW

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to formally object to the proposed change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Place of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub), including the proposed extensions, increase in height, and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

While I appreciate the value of community facilities, this proposal raises several significant concerns.

Parking and Highway Safety:

The proposed use is likely to generate substantially higher visitor numbers, particularly during evenings and weekends. The area already suffers from limited on-street parking, and there is insufficient evidence that the site can accommodate peak demand. Overspill parking would likely cause congestion, obstruct driveways and junctions, and compromise access for emergency vehicles.

Pedestrian Safety and Late-Night Activity:

The development would significantly increase pedestrian movements, including during late hours. The surrounding residential streets are not designed for high footfall at night, raising concerns about noise, disturbance, highway safety, and potential anti-social behaviour during dispersal after events.

Scale and Overdevelopment:

The proposed part one, part two-storey extensions and increase in height represent a substantial intensification of the site. The scale and massing appear disproportionate within the residential

context and may result in visual dominance, loss of light, and harm to the character of the area.

Noise and Residential Amenity:

Religious services, meetings, events, and gatherings are likely to generate ongoing noise, particularly in the evenings and at weekends. The application lacks sufficient detail regarding operating hours, capacity limits, and noise mitigation measures to safeguard neighbouring amenity.

Refuse and Servicing:

Increased activity will result in greater waste generation and servicing requirements, potentially leading to additional congestion, visual impact, and nuisance if not properly managed.

In summary, the proposal represents a material intensification of use that would adversely affect parking, highway and pedestrian safety, residential amenity, and the character of this predominantly residential area. I therefore respectfully request that the application be refused.